

MERLYN

FIRST APPEARANCE Black Knight #1 (May 1955)
REAL NAME Merlyn
OCCUPATION Sorcerer, guardian of the multiverse
BASE Otherworld **HEIGHT/WEIGHT/EYES/HAIR** Variable
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Almost unlimited command of sorcerous energies allow him to perform innumerable feats, including extending his natural lifespan.



Born a powerful immortal in an alternate universe, Merlyn studied under Necrom, and with him and his fellow student Feron, he helped attune the various universes together to link the multiverse in a magical Matrix. With his daughter Roma, he created the

Captain Britain Corps to safeguard all the parallel Earths of the multiverse, then later manipulated Roma and Captain Britain into forming Excalibur when they thought he was dead. After Excalibur destroyed the source of his power he disappeared, but he later returned to attack Captain Britain and kill Roma. **TB, MF**

MI-13

FIRST APPEARANCE Excalibur #101 (September 1996)
BASE UK **MEMBERS AND POWERS** Black Knight (Dane Whitman) Wields the Ebony Blade. Blade (Eric Brooks) Half-vampire vampire hunter. Captain Britain (Brian Braddock) Superhuman strength, durability, and flight. Faiza Hussain Control over living bodies. John the Skrull Shapeshifting and flight. Spitfire (Jacqueline Falsworth) Superhuman speed and durability, fangs, and healing factor.

MI-13 is the branch of British Intelligence charged with the investigation of supernatural phenomena. Alistair Stuart founded it from the remnants of the Weird Happenings Organisation (WHO), but he handed over the reins to his top agent, Peter Wisdom (see WISDOM, PETER), when he left to join MI-6. During Secret Invasion (see pp.326-7), the Prime Minister drafted all UK Super Heroes into MI-13. To keep the SKRULLS out of Avalon, MI-13 had to unleash the demons from that magical dimension. While this worked, it meant that MI-13 had a lot of cleaning up to do. CAPTAIN BRITAIN now leads MI-13's semiautonomous strike team. **MF**

MESMERO

Mesmero started out as a party hypnotist, using his mutant powers to convince guests to surrender their valuables. He branched out into supervillainy when the MACHINESMITH recruited him to lead the robotic "Demi-Men" alongside a robot duplicate of MAGNETO. Mesmero, who didn't realize that his comrades were robots, hypnotized POLARIS into becoming his partner until the X-Men crushed the Machinesmith's plot.

Mesmero later found work as a stage hypnotist and clashed with SPIDER-MAN. He recently served as a field agent for the WEAPON X program in exchange for treatments that augmented his hypnotic abilities. His powers let him entrance crowds into doing anything he wished, putting Mesmero's mind-control abilities in the same class as PROFESSOR X. Mesmero helped hide the locations of Weapon X installations, but his superiors abandoned him when his power levels dipped after the death of his mother.

Mesmero was one of the mutants who saw their abilities stripped by the SCARLET WITCH during the Decimation event. Without his hypnotism, Mesmero finally forged a relationship with a woman that didn't rely on trickery. He has rededicated himself to starting a new life as an ordinary human. **DW**



Mesmero, who knew that he was a supremely powerful mutant, was also an insufferable egotist.



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Vincent (full name unrevealed)

OCCUPATION

Professional criminal

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

5 ft 10 in

WEIGHT

180 lbs

EYES

Red

HAIR

Green

FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Men Vol. 1 #49
(October 1968)

Mutant powers of hypnotism allow him to take control of others. Mesmero does this by making eye contact. His powers can induce amnesia, put memories into a victim's head or even change their personality.

POWERS

MICROCHIP

FIRST APPEARANCE Punisher Vol. 2 #4 (November 1987)
REAL NAME Linus Lieberman
OCCUPATION Mechanic, computer hacker, inventor
BASE New Jersey **HEIGHT** 5 ft 8 in **WEIGHT** 220 lbs
EYES Green **HAIR** Brown
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES No superhuman abilities; highly skilled computer hacker; weapons engineer.



A former weapons engineer, Linus Lieberman put his skills to work building the PUNISHER's arsenal. Calling himself Microchip, he became a close friend and confidante of the Punisher—and also a

target of the Punisher's enemies. The KINGPIN had Microchip kidnapped, then cut off his finger and sent it to the Punisher in the mail. Microchip also lost his son Louis Frohike (Microchip Jr.) to the Punisher's war on crime. Microchip once appeared to be killed by Stone Cold, a rogue SHIELD agent, but he returned to try to persuade the Punisher to join the CIA. The Punisher killed him instead. **MT, MF**

Skilled in strategy, Microchip often planned the Punisher's missions.

